

## Chapter 30 — Piel Semantic Function Sorting

*BBH Chapter 30 · Piel Strong Verbs*

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Classify each Piel verb: I (Intensive), F (Factitive), D (Declarative), DN (Denominative), or SA (Simple Action). Answer key is on the last page.

I = Intensive (more forceful/thorough than Qal) | F = Factitive (causes object to be in a state; from stative root) | D = Declarative (declares/treats something as being in a state) | DN = Denominative (derived from a noun; performs noun's action) | SA = Simple Action (Piel is primary form; no productive Qal)

| #  | Hebrew       | Conjugation    | Ref       | Contextual Gloss                     | Function |
|----|--------------|----------------|-----------|--------------------------------------|----------|
| 1  | יְבָרַךְ     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 1:22  | "God blessed them"                   |          |
| 2  | יִקְדֹּשׁ    | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 2:3   | "he set it apart as holy"            |          |
| 3  | יָכַל        | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 2:2   | "he finished"                        |          |
| 4  | שָׁחַת       | Inf. Construct | Gen 6:17  | "to destroy utterly"                 |          |
| 5  | יָצַו        | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 2:16  | "he commanded"                       |          |
| 6  | יִגְרֹשׁ     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 3:24  | "he drove out forcibly"              |          |
| 7  | חִיּוֹת      | Inf. Construct | Gen 7:3   | "to preserve alive"                  |          |
| 8  | יִשְׁלַח     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 8:7   | "he sent out / released"             |          |
| 9  | יָכֹסוּ      | Wayyiqtol 3mp  | Gen 9:23  | "they thoroughly covered"            |          |
| 10 | יִדְבָּר     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 8:15  | "he spoke"                           |          |
| 11 | יִשָּׁרֵת    | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 39:4  | "he served"                          |          |
| 12 | אֶגְדֹּלָה   | Yiqtol 1cs     | Gen 12:2  | "I will make great"                  |          |
| 13 | מְקַלֵּל     | Participle ms  | Gen 12:3  | "one who curses"                     |          |
| 14 | יִגַּע       | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 12:17 | "he struck / afflicted"              |          |
| 15 | וְקִדְשָׁתָם | Weqatal 2ms    | Exo 19:10 | "you shall consecrate them"          |          |
| 16 | וְכָבְסוּ    | Weqatal 3cp    | Exo 19:10 | "and they shall wash their garments" |          |
| 17 | יְהַלְלוּ    | Wayyiqtol 3mp  | Gen 12:15 | "they praised her"                   |          |
| 18 | יִבְקֹשׁ     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 37:15 | "he sought"                          |          |
| 19 | לְנַחֵם      | Inf. Construct | Gen 37:35 | "to comfort him"                     |          |
| 20 | צָוָה        | Perfect 3ms    | Gen 6:22  | "he commanded"                       |          |
| 21 | לְכַפֵּר     | Inf. Construct | Lev 4:20  | "to make atonement"                  |          |
| 22 | יַחְלִיל     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Lev 21:12 | "he would profane"                   |          |
| 23 | בִּקֵּשׁ     | Perfect 3ms    | Gen 43:30 | "he sought"                          |          |
| 24 | יְנַחֵם      | Yiqtol 3ms     | Gen 5:29  | "he will comfort us"                 |          |
| 25 | לְהַלֵּל     | Inf. Construct | Psa 113:1 | "to praise"                          |          |

### Reflection Questions

- Items 1, 5, 10, 17, 20, 24 are all SA. What do these roots share? Why does "intensification of the Qal" not work for them?
- Items 2, 7, 12, 15, 22 are all Factitive. For each root, name the Qal stative meaning and explain how the Piel "causes" that state.
- Item 21 (לְכַפֵּר): if this is Denominative, what noun is it from? How does knowing that noun illuminate its meaning in Lev 4:20?

## Answer Key

| #  | Hebrew         | Ref       | Fn | Explanation                                                |
|----|----------------|-----------|----|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | יִבְרַךְ       | Gen 1:22  | SA | Piel is the primary form; no intensified Qal counterpart   |
| 2  | יִקְדֹּשׁ      | Gen 2:3   | F  | Qal = be holy; Piel = cause to be holy (factitive)         |
| 3  | יָמַל          | Gen 2:2   | I  | Thorough completion; Qal = be complete                     |
| 4  | שָׁחַת         | Gen 6:17  | I  | Total/thorough destruction; intensive force                |
| 5  | יָצָא          | Gen 2:16  | SA | Piel is the standard form; Qal is marginal                 |
| 6  | יִגְרֹשׁ       | Gen 3:24  | I  | Forcible expulsion; more intensive than basic Qal          |
| 7  | חָיָה          | Gen 7:3   | F  | Qal = live; Piel = cause to be alive (factitive)           |
| 8  | יִשְׁלַח       | Gen 8:7   | I  | Release/send away with force; Qal = send                   |
| 9  | יָסָה          | Gen 9:23  | I  | Thorough covering; Qal = cover                             |
| 10 | יִדְבֹּר       | Gen 8:15  | SA | Piel is standard form for "to speak"; Qal is rare          |
| 11 | יִשְׁמַח       | Gen 39:4  | SA | Piel is primary form; denominative from שָׂמַח             |
| 12 | אֶגְדֹּלָהּ    | Gen 12:2  | F  | Qal = be great; Piel = cause to be great (factitive)       |
| 13 | מִקְלָל        | Gen 12:3  | D  | Qal = be light/small; Piel = declare accursed              |
| 14 | יִגַּעַ        | Gen 12:17 | I  | Intensive striking/affliction; more severe than Qal        |
| 15 | יִקְדֹּשֶׁתָּם | Exo 19:10 | F  | Cause the people to be in a holy state                     |
| 16 | יִכְבְּסוּ     | Exo 19:10 | I  | Thorough washing; Qal of כָּבַס is rare                    |
| 17 | יִהְלִל        | Gen 12:15 | SA | Piel is standard form for "to praise"                      |
| 18 | יִבְקֹשׁ       | Gen 37:15 | I  | Diligent/intensive seeking                                 |
| 19 | לְנַחֵם        | Gen 37:35 | I  | Active comforting; Niphal = be comforted                   |
| 20 | צָוָה          | Gen 6:22  | SA | Same root as #5; Piel is the operative form                |
| 21 | לְכַפֵּר       | Lev 4:20  | DN | From כָּפַר "ransom/covering"; denominative function       |
| 22 | יִחַלֵּל       | Lev 21:12 | F  | Qal = be profane; Piel = cause to be profane               |
| 23 | בִּקֵּשׁ       | Gen 43:30 | I  | Same root as #18; intensive seeking                        |
| 24 | יִנַּחֵם       | Gen 5:29  | SA | Active sense; Niphal = relent/be comforted; Piel = comfort |
| 25 | לְהִלֵּל       | Psa 113:1 | SA | Standard form for praise; same root as #17                 |